

Yining Nie [jɪˈnɪŋ ˈniː]

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CV updated: April 2025

Academic Appointments

- 2022– **Assistant Professor**
Department of Linguistics and Language Development, San José State University
- 2021–2022 **Postdoctoral Researcher**
Department of English and American Studies, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin
ERC Synergy Project *Realizing Leibniz’s Dream: Child Languages as a Mirror of the Mind* (PIs: Artemis Alexiadou, Maria Teresa Guasti, Uli Sauerland)

Education

- 2020 **Ph.D. in Linguistics**, Department of Linguistics, New York University
Dissertation: *Licensing arguments*
Committee: Alec Marantz (chair), Stephanie Harves, Richard Kayne, Gary Thoms, Laura Kalin (Princeton University)
- 2019 **M.Phil. in Linguistics**, Department of Linguistics, New York University
- 2015 **M.A. in Linguistics**, Department of Linguistics, University of Toronto
Thesis: *French morphology and the pieces of verbal inflection*
Advisor: Elizabeth Cowper
- 2014 **B.A. (Hons.) in Linguistics**, Trinity College, University of Cambridge

Non-degree Training

- 2017 Linguistic Society of America Linguistic Institute, University of Kentucky
- 2012 Certificate in Humanities Computing for Languages, University of Cambridge

Grants and Awards

- 2025–2028 DFG Scientific Network *Applicative alternations across languages*, German Research Foundation (Coordinators: Jens Hopperdietzel, Jozina Vander Klok, András Bárány)
- 2023–2025 RSCA Seed Grant, Division of Research and Innovation, San José State University
- 2017–2019 Bernard and Julia Bloch Memorial Fellowship, Linguistic Society of America
- 2016–2020 SSHRC Doctoral Fellowship, Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada
- 2016–2019 Joseph-Armand Bombardier Canada Graduate Scholarships Doctoral Fellowship, Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada (declined)
- 2015 B. Elan Dresher Phonology Prize, Department of Linguistics, University of Toronto
- 2011–2014 Blyth Cambridge Commonwealth Trust Scholarship, Blyth Education & Cambridge Commonwealth Trust

Publications

Peer-reviewed Journal Articles

- To appear **Nie, Yining** and Henrison Hsieh. Tagalog valency morphology and its neutralization. *Studia Linguistica*.
- 2025 **Nie, Yining**. Turkish causatives are recursive: A response to Key 2013. *Linguistic Inquiry* 56(2): 401–414. DOI: 10.1162/ling_a_00472
- 2024 Hein, Johannes, Imke Driemel, Fabienne Martin, **Yining Nie** and Artemis Alexiadou. Errors of multiple exponence in child English: A study of past tense formation. *Morphology* (published online). DOI: 10.1007/s11525-024-09434-x
- 2024 **Nie, Yining**. Applicative recursion and nominal licensing. *Linguistic Inquiry* 55(4): 725–768. DOI: 10.1162/ling_a_00513
- 2021 Kouneli, Maria and **Yining Nie**. Across-the-board tonal polarity in Kipsigis: Implications for the morphology-phonology interface. *Language* 92(2): e111–e138. DOI: 10.1353/lan.2021.0030
- 2020 **Nie, Yining**. Morphological causatives are Voice over Voice. *Word Structure* 13(1): 102–126. DOI: 10.3366/word.2020.0161
- 2019 **Nie, Yining**. Raising applicatives and possessors in Tagalog. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 14(1), 139: 1–30. DOI: 10.5334/gjgl.941
- 2019 Warstadt, Alex, Yu Cao, Ioana Grosu, Wei Peng, Hagen Blix, **Yining Nie**, Anna Alsop, Shikha Bordia, Haokun Liu, Alicia Parrish, Sheng-Fu Wang, Jason Phang, Anhad Mohananey, Phu Mon Htut, Paloma Jeretič and Samuel R. Bowman. Investigating BERT’s Knowledge of Language: Five Analysis Methods with NPIs. *Proceedings of the 2019 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*. DOI: 10.18653/v1/D19-1286

Edited Volume

- 2020 Manova, Stela, Harald Hammarström, Itamar Kastner and **Yining Nie**. *What is in a morpheme?* *Word Structure* 13(1). Edinburgh University Press. ISSN: 1750-1245.

Conference Proceedings

- To appear Saelee, Low and **Yining Nie**. Adjectives are not verbs in Iu Mien. *Proceedings of the Linguistic Society of America* 10.
- To appear Saelee, Low and **Yining Nie**. Adjective ordering in Iu Mien. In Mark Alves (ed.), *JSEALS Special Publication 13: Papers from the 33rd Conference of the Southeast Asian Linguistics Society (2024)*, 229–239. Honolulu, HI: University of Hawai’i Press.
- 2024 Hein, Johannes, Imke Driemel, Fabienne Martin, **Yining Nie** and Artemis Alexiadou. Errors of multiple exponence in child language. In Jiayi Lu, Erika Petersen, Anissa Zaitsu and Boris Harizanov (eds.), *Proceedings of the 40th West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics*, 122–131. Somerville, MA: Cascadilla Proceedings Project.
- 2024 Buenrostro, Ruby and **Yining Nie**. Ordering preferences in Ukrainian multiple *wh*-fronting. *Proceedings of the Linguistic Society of America* 9(1): 5661. DOI: 10.3765/plsa.v9i1.5661.

- 2022 Lee, Soo-Hwan and **Yining Nie**. Korean case stacking and the nominal template. In Johanna Benz and Yiran Chen (eds.), *University of Pennsylvania Working Papers in Linguistics 28: Proceedings of 45th Annual Penn Linguistics Conference*, Article 11.
- 2022 Martin, Fabienne, **Yining Nie**, Artemis Alexiadou and Maria Teresa Guasti. Wearing causation on its sleeve: Overt *cause* in child French causatives. In Ying Gong and Felix Kpogo (eds.), *Proceedings of 46th Annual Boston University Conference on Language Development*, 497–510. Somerville, MA: Cascadilla Press.
- 2018 **Nie, Yining**. Contrast and prosody in derived environment effects. *Toronto Working Papers in Linguistics 40: Special issue from the Canada Research Chair-sponsored Phonology/Phonetics Workshops*.
- 2017 **Nie, Yining**. Why is there NOM-NOM and ACC-ACC but no ERG-ERG? In Andrew Lamont and Katerina Tetzloff (eds.), *Proceedings of 47th Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society, Volume 2*, 315–328.
- 2017 **Nie, Yining**. Phonetic enhancement and three patterns of English a-tensing. In Kajsa Djärv and Amy Goodwin Davies (eds.), *University of Pennsylvania Working Papers in Linguistics 23: Proceedings of 40th Annual Penn Linguistics Colloquium*, Article 21.
- 2016 **Nie, Yining**. Why is there NOM-NOM but no ERG-ERG? *Toronto Working Papers in Linguistics 36: Proceedings of the Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton 2016 Syntax Workshop*.
- 2015 **Nie, Yining**. Tense and modality in French verbal morphology. In Santa Vīnerte (ed.), *Proceedings of the 2015 Annual Conference of the Canadian Linguistics Association*.

Invited Contributions

- 2024 **Nie, Yining**. Jim Wood: *Icelandic nominalizations and allosemy*. Book review, *Folia Linguistica* 58(2): 571–579. DOI: 10.1515/flin-2024-2030
- 2020 Manova, Stela, Harald Hammarström, Itamar Kastner and **Yining Nie**. What is in a morpheme? Theoretical, experimental and computational approaches to the relation of meaning and form in morphology. *Word Structure* 13(1) 1–21. DOI: 10.3366/word.2020.0157
- 2018 Hsieh, Henrison and **Yining Nie**. Where (and what) the Tagalog *kung*-CPs are. In Laura Kalin, Ileana Paul and Jozina Vander Klok (eds.), *Heading in the right direction: Linguistic Treats for Lisa Travis. McGill Working Papers in Linguistics 25*.

Unpublished Manuscripts

- 2017 Nie, Yining. Voice morphology and the features of vP. New York University: ms. lingbuzz/003750

Other Resources

- LITMUS Quasi-universal Nonword Repetition Tests (<http://www.bi-sli.org/qu-nonword-repetition>):
- Italian, with Silvia Silleresi and Maria Teresa Guasti
 - Hungarian, with Lilla Pintér

Presentations

Invited Talks

- 2024 Voice-over-Voice causatives. Converging on Causal Ontology Analyses, Structures Formelles du Langage, Centre national de la recherche scientifique (CNRS)/Université Paris 8, France, December 13 (virtual).
- 2024 Distinguishing Tagalog valency and voice. Keynote, *31st Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association*, University of Massachusetts Amherst, June 12–14.
- 2024 What can Tagalog teach us about causation? *The impact of Tagalog in Psycholinguistics and Formal Linguistics*, Queen Mary University of London, UK, March 22 (virtual).
- 2024 The cross-linguistic expression of causation. Colloquium, Simon Fraser University, Canada, March 4.
- 2023 with Ruby Buenrostro. Ordering preferences in Ukrainian multiple *wh*-fronting. Syntax and Morphology Circle, Stanford University, November 10.
- 2023 with Fabienne Martin. Interpreting (the absence of) *se* under *faire* in French. Research Unit on (Experimental) Syntax and Heritage Languages, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, Germany, July 10.
- 2023 Causatives and ambiguity in French and Italian. Syntax and Semantics Circle, University of California, Berkeley, April 21.
- 2023 Causatives and ambiguity in French and Italian. Syntax and Semantics Circle, University of California, Santa Cruz, April 7.
- 2022 Recursion and thematic relations in causatives. Keynote, *15th Brussels Conference in Generative Linguistics*, Center for Research in Syntax, Semantics and Phonology (CRISSP), KU Leuven, Belgium, October 6–7.
- 2022 with Johannes Hein, Imke Driemel, Fabienne Martin and Artemis Alexiadou. Redundant errors in child language. Colloquium, University of Leipzig, Germany, July 13.
- 2022 Two ways of forming causatives and their implications for recursion. Colloquium, San José State University, March 2 (virtual).
- 2022 Two ways of forming causatives and their implications for recursion. Colloquium, University of California, Santa Cruz, February 23.
- 2021 Event distinctness and the cross-linguistic expression of causation. Colloquium, McMaster University, Canada, March 16 (virtual).
- 2021 The syntax of double object constructions: Evidence from recursion and symmetry. Colloquium, University of Konstanz, Germany, January 11 (virtual).
- 2020 Two ways of forming causatives and their implications for recursion. Comparative Syntax (ComSyn) group, Leiden University, the Netherlands, October 29 (virtual).
- 2019 The limits of applicative recursion. Syntactic Theory @ Rutgers, Rutgers University, November 20.

- 2015 Contrast and prosodic preservation in derived environment effects. Keynote, *2015 Canada Research Chair-sponsored Summer Phonetics/Phonology Workshop*, University of Toronto, Canada, June 8.
- 2013 with Bert Vaux. Learning theory and language change: The evolution of phonological scope. Colloquium, University of Cambridge, UK, October 24.

Conference Talks

- 2025 Saelee, Low and Yining Nie. Adjectives are not verbs in Iu Mien. *Linguistic Society of America 2025 Annual Meeting*, Philadelphia, January 9–12.
- 2024 Hein, Johannes, Imke Driemel, Fabienne Martin and Yining Nie. Overt PAST on irregular verbs in child English due to secondary feature negligence. *16th Generative Approaches to Language Acquisition*, NOVA University of Lisbon, Portugal, September 12–14.
- 2024 Dal Farra, Chiara, Silvia Silleresi, Fabienne Martin, Yining Nie, Artemis Alexiadou and Maria Teresa Guasti. Does occluding the agent's body affect Italian children's production of argument structure? *16th Generative Approaches to Language Acquisition*, NOVA University of Lisbon, Portugal, September 12–14.
- 2024 Saelee, Low and Yining Nie. Adjective ordering in Iu Mien. *33rd Annual Meeting of the Southeast Asian Linguistics Society*, National Tsing Hua University, Taiwan, June 15–17 (hybrid).
- 2024 Buenrostro, Ruby and Yining Nie. Ordering preferences in Ukrainian multiple *wh*-fronting. *Linguistic Society of America 2024 Annual Meeting*, New York City, January 4–7.
- 2023 Martin, Fabienne, Yining Nie and Artemis Alexiadou. A preposition cycle in French. *Going Romance 37*, Radboud Universiteit, the Netherlands, November 30–December 1.
- 2023 Nie, Yining and Henrison Hsieh. Tagalog valency morphology and its neutralization. *30th Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association*, Lund University, Sweden, October 20–22.
- 2023 Martin, Fabienne, Yining Nie, Silvia Silleresi, Chiara Dal Farra, Artemis Alexiadou and Maria Teresa Guasti. Agent bias in child Italian event descriptions. *Linguistic Society of America 2023 Annual Meeting*, Denver, Colorado, January 5–8.
- 2022 Martin, Fabienne, Yining Nie, Silvia Silleresi, Chiara Dal Farra, Artemis Alexiadou and Maria Teresa Guasti. Agentivity in child and adult Italian event descriptions. *Going Romance 2022*, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, November 30–December 2.
- 2022 Silleresi, Silvia, Chiara Dal Farra, Fabienne Martin, Yining Nie, Artemis Alexiadou and Maria Teresa Guasti. The agent bias holds in production too: Event descriptions in child Italian. *47th Boston University Conference on Language Development*, Boston University, November 3–6.
- 2022 Dal Farra, Chiara, Fabienne Martin, Maria Teresa Guasti and Artemis Alexiadou. Bigger is better! Older Italian children prefer heavy locative prepositions. *15th Generative Approaches to Language Acquisition Conference*, Goethe-Universität Frankfurt, Germany, September 22–24.

- 2022 Martin, Fabienne, Yining Nie, Chiara Dal Farra and Silvia Silleresi. Who did it? How alternating verbs are interpreted under *faire*. *Syntactic Conferences at the University of Palermo 2022: The syntax of causative, perception and restructuring verbs in Romance and Latin*, University of Palermo, Italy, May 26–27.
- 2022 Hein, Johannes, Fabienne Martin, Yining Nie and Artemis Alexiadou. Minimizing and maximizing exponence in child language. *40th West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics*, Stanford University, May 13–15 (virtual).
- 2021 Alexiadou, Artemis, Imke Driemel, Johannes Hein, Fabienne Martin and Yining Nie. Multiple exponence in child language. *Multiple Exponence @ ZAS*, Leibniz-ZAS Berlin, December 1–3 (virtual).
- 2021 Martin, Fabienne, Elisabeth Backes, Daniil Bondarenko and Yining Nie. Variation in the actuality inference of circumstantial modals. *Going Romance 2021*, Amsterdam, December 1–3 (virtual).
- 2021 Martin, Fabienne, Yining Nie, Artemis Alexiadou and Maria Teresa Guasti. Wearing causation on its sleeve: Overt CAUSE in child French causatives. *46th Boston University Conference on Language Development*, Boston University, November 4–7 (virtual).
- 2021 Martin, Fabienne, Elisabeth Backes, Daniil Bondarenko and Yining Nie. Variation in the actuality inference of circumstantial modals. *Sensus 2021*, University of Massachusetts Amherst, October 1–2 (virtual).
- 2021 Lee, Soo-Hwan and Yining Nie. Korean case stacking and the nominal template. *45th Annual Penn Linguistics Conference*, University of Pennsylvania, March 19–21 (virtual).
- 2020 Nie, Yining. Double causatives are real. *51st Meeting of the North East Linguistics Society*, Université du Québec à Montréal, November 6–8 (virtual).
- 2020 Hsieh, Henrison and Yining Nie. Tagalog gerunds are antipassive. “Remarks: the Legacy” Workshop, *43rd Generative Linguistics in the Old World Colloquium*, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, April 8–20 (virtual).
- 2019 Warstadt, Alex, Yu Cao, Ioana Grosu, Wei Peng, Hagen Blix, Yining Nie, Anna Alsop, Shikha Bordia, Haokun Liu, Alicia Parrish, Sheng-Fu Wang, Jason Phang, Anhad Mohananey, Phu Mon Htut, Paloma Jeretić and Samuel R. Bowman. Investigating BERT’s Knowledge of Language: Five Analysis Methods with NPIs. *2019 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, Hong Kong, November 3–7.
- 2019 Nie, Yining, Ollie Sayeed and Bert Vaux. Scope expansion: an asymmetry in phonological change. *24th International Conference of Historical Linguistics*, Australian National University, July 1–5.
- 2019 Nie, Yining. Raising applicatives in Tagalog. *26th Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association*, Western University (University of Western Ontario), May 24–26.
- 2018 Kouneli, Maria and Yining Nie. Paradigmatic tonal polarity in Kipsigis nominal modifiers. *49th Meeting of the North East Linguistics Society*, Cornell University, October 5–7.
- 2018 Nie, Yining. Voice and Austronesian-type voice morphology. *Linguistic Society of America 2018 Annual Meeting*, Salt Lake City, Utah, January 4–7.

- 2018 Hsieh, Henrison and Yining Nie. Clausal arguments in Tagalog. Symposium on The Syntax of Clausal Arguments, *Linguistic Society of America 2018 Annual Meeting*, Salt Lake City, Utah, January 4–7.
- 2017 Nie, Yining. Austronesian voice morphology and the structure of causatives. *11th Arizona Linguistics Circle*, University of Arizona, October 20–22.
- 2017 Nie, Yining. Ergative Voice and the features of transitivity. *vP workshop*, University of Cambridge, June 17.
- 2016 Nie, Yining. Why is there NOM-NOM but no ERG-ERG? *47th Meeting of the North East Linguistics Society*, University of Massachusetts Amherst, October 14–16.
- 2016 Nie, Yining. Why is there NOM-NOM but no ERG-ERG? *Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton 2016 Syntax Workshop*, University of Toronto Mississauga, April 15–16.
- 2016 Nie, Yining. Phonetic enhancement and three patterns of English a-tensing. *40th Annual Penn Linguistics Conference*, University of Pennsylvania, March 18–20.
- 2016 Nie, Yining. Derived environment effects are prosodic, not morphological. *24th Conference of the Student Organisation of Linguistics in Europe*, York, UK, January 6–8.
- 2015 Nie, Yining. Go-support in the Québec French futures. *2015 Stony Brook-Yale-NYU-CUNY Graduate Linguistics Conference*, New York University, December 3.
- 2015 Nie, Yining. Tense and modality in French verbal morphology. *2015 Annual Conference of the Canadian Linguistics Association*, University of Ottawa, May 30–June 1.
- 2015 Nie, Yining. Morphological truncation in Harmonic Serialism. *Montréal-Ottawa-Laval-Toronto 2015 Phonology Workshop*, University of Toronto, March 13–15.

Conference Posters

- 2024 Nie, Yining, Fabienne Martin, Chiara Dal Farra and Silvia Silleresi. Interpreting causatives: The case of *faire se* in French and Italian. *Linguistic Society of America 2024 Annual Meeting*, New York City, January 4–7.
- 2023 Hein, Johannes, Imke Driemel, Fabienne Martin, Yining Nie and Artemis Alexiadou. Errors of redundancy in child English and beyond. *46th Generative Linguistics in the Old World Colloquium*, University of Vienna and University of Graz, Austria, April 11–15.
- 2021 Martin, Fabienne, Yining Nie, Artemis Alexiadou and Maria Teresa Guasti. Two causatives for the price of one in child French. *Sensus 2021*, University of Massachusetts Amherst, October 1–2 (virtual).
- 2021 Lee, Soo-Hwan and Yining Nie. Korean case stacking and triple nominatives. *Linguistic Society of America 2021 Annual Meeting*, January 7–10 (virtual).
- 2019 Nie, Yining, Ollie Sayeed and Bert Vaux. Scope expansion: an asymmetry in phonological change. *5th Workshop on Sound Change*, University of California, Davis, June 21–23.
- 2019 Nie, Yining. Applicatives and the parameters of promotion. *Parameters Workshop in honour of Lisa Travis*, McGill University, May 17–18.
- 2019 Nie, Yining. Re- frozen scope in *spray-load* constructions. *Linguistic Society of America 2019 Annual Meeting*, New York City, January 3–6.

- 2018 Nie, Yining. Possessor raising and adversity in Tagalog. *25th Meeting of the Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association*, Academia Sinica, Taiwan, May 10–12.
- 2016 Nie, Yining. Prosodic conditioning in derived environment effects. *13th Old World Conference in Phonology*, Budapest, Hungary, January 13–16.

Teaching and Advising

San José State University

Courses Taught

- Introduction to Linguistics (BA): 5×, most recently Spring 2025
- Introduction to Syntax (BA): 6×, most recently Spring 2025
- Introduction to Semantics and Discourse (BA): 3×, most recently Fall 2024
- Introduction to Phonology (BA): Spring 2024
- Syntactic Theory (MA): Spring 2023
- Semantic Structures (MA): Fall 2022

Student Supervised

- Ruby Buenrostro (MA): Ordering preferences in Ukrainian multiple *wh*-fronting (2023)
- Sarah Gerlach (MA): Argument accessibility in French event descriptions (2023–24)
- Low Saelee (MA): Adjective ordering in Iu Mien (2023)
- Denny O'Shea (MA): Effect of morphology on the interpretation of Spanish verbs (2023)

Other Teaching

Courses Taught

- Introduction to Linguistics (BA): New York University (Summer 2018)

Guest Lectures

- Advanced Syntax (BA): New York University
- Advanced Semantics (BA): University of California Santa Cruz
- Syntax Seminar (MA/PhD): Yale University, New York University, McGill University, University of Leipzig, University of Massachusetts Amherst

Service

Linguistic Society of America

- 2022– Committee on Linguistic Institutes and Fellowships
- 2018 Strategic Planning Committee (LSA Long-range Strategic Plan 2019–2023)
- 2017–2019 Executive Committee (ex officio as Bloch Fellow)
- 2017–2019 Chair, Committee on Student Issues and Concerns

San José State University

- 2024– Computational Linguistics Search Committee, Department of Linguistics and Language Development
- 2023– Research Committee, College of Humanities and the Arts
- 2022–2023 MA Curriculum Committee, Department of Linguistics and Language Development
- 2022– Curriculum Committee, Department of Linguistics and Language Development

New York University

- 2016–2019 Co-organizer, Morph Beer (morphology reading group), Department of Linguistics
- 2016–2017 President, Linguistics Association of NYU, Department of Linguistics

Conference Organization

- 2022 Austronesian and Papuan Languages and Linguistics Conference 14
Leibniz-ZAS and HU Berlin, June 9–11 (hybrid)
- 2019 MarantzFest
New York University, January 6
- 2018 Symposium on The Syntax of Clausal Arguments
Linguistic Society of America 2018 Annual Meeting
Salt Lake City, Utah, January 4–7
- 2017 Annual Meeting on Phonology 2017
New York University, September 15–17

Ad-hoc Reviewing

Grant Proposals

- National Science Foundation (Linguistics, DDRI)

Journal Articles

- *Linguistic Inquiry*, *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory*, *Journal of Linguistics*, *Syntax*, *Glossa: A journal of general linguistics*, *The Linguistic Review*, *Studia Linguistica*, *Journal of East Asian Linguistics*, *Journal of Comparative Germanic Linguistics*, *Frontiers in Psychology: Language Sciences*, *Languages*, *NUSA: Linguistic studies of languages in and around Indonesia*

Conference Abstracts

- Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting (LSA), West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL), North East Linguistics Society (NELS), Austronesian Formal Linguistics Association (AFLA), Brussels Conference in Generative Linguistics (BCGL), Austronesian and Papuan Languages and Linguistics Conference (APLL), Workshop on Turkic and Languages in Contact with Turkic (Tu+), Stony Brook-Yale-NYU-CUNY Conference (SYNC)

Languages

- Spoken: English (native), Mandarin (heritage, intermediate), French (intermediate), German (basic), Tagalog (basic)
- Current research: Tagalog, French, Italian, Korean
- Previous research: Turkish, Japanese, Kipsigis (Nilotic; Kenya), Khoekhoe (Central Khoisan; Namibia), Inuktitut
- Programming/Analysis: Python, R, CLAN